an exhibition and catalog honoring him. Friend, former student, and fellow American expatriate Dorothy Iannone wrote in the catalog's accompanying essay, "The most wonderful thing about the class of Shinkichi Tajiri is that everyone feels free to do what they want. The way toward self-expression is not barred by the imposition of any aesthetic system or method." Iannone added, "The word, it seems has spread [internationally] that in Berlin there is a class which helps you on your way."[24] Tajiri remained close with students after his retirement and was slated to return to Berlin in November 1989 for an exhibition of his paper knots at the Galerie Horst Dietrich. However, when attendance was reportedly low, he suspected the other opening in town, of the newly breached Wall, might have overshadowed his exhibition. (Tajiri was inadvertently featured in a local television broadcast about the demise of the border.) This unexpected conflict did not affect Tajiri, as he returned soon after to observe the dismantling of the Wall. Again fascinated by the Wall's materiality, he now observed its state of deconstruction and imposed decomposition. He recalled in his autobiography, "Immediately a new industry was born. Enterprising individuals and then whole families hacked away at the surface and sold fragments to tourists. An unequipped visitor could rent a hammer and a chisel for 5 marks an hour and carry off his own mementoes."[25] Tajiri made more photographic portraits by what remained of the Wall. In one, he lined up in front of an impromptu mirrored mosaic placed on its pockmarked surface and snapped a picture of himself. In another (fig. 5.5), he posed in front of a gaping hole in the Wall left by *Mauerpeckers*, as if he had emerged from the other side. His fascination after 1989 afforded him new opportunities. On January 9, 1990, he reported that he made his "last series of portraits," as "90 percent of it was still there, penetrated with large holes." He carried home pieces of the Wall, which he lined up along the windowsills of his studio in Baarlo.[26]